



INSECTIVORES

Insectivores are sharp-toothed, long-nosed animals that eat insects and juicy worms, slugs, and snails! Their busy little bodies lose heat easily, so they need to eat frequently. The food they eat produces the energy needed to keep them warm. But how do insectivores survive winters, when there are fewer insects to eat? Shrews search through rotting leaves and most manage to find enough food. Moles stay underground, and hedgehogs spend cold winters in a deep sleep, called hibernation.

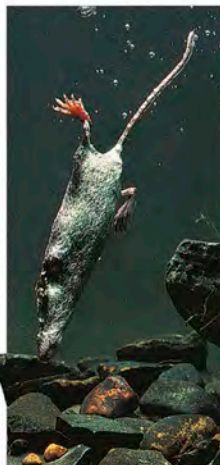


How hungry?

Imagine having to eat a pile of food that weighs twice as much you—shrews have to do this every day!

The tiny eyes are covered by fur. A mole can barely tell the difference between light and dark.

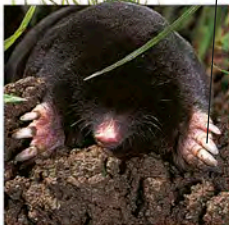
Little bumps on its tail and its nose help this European mole sense where it is going.



A bite for lunch

The water shrew is one of the few venomous mammals. Its saliva can kill frogs, but not people!

A mole's wide front feet are shaped like spades—ideal for digging.



Moles live alone. This worm thief will soon be chased away.

Molehill

The grass nest is the size of a football.

Worms burrow into the tunnel and are caught by the mole.

Moles turn around by doing forward rolls. If the tunnel is too narrow, they run backward.

Moles eat more than 50 worms a day! Live ones are stored in a pantry.

